

DAVID MULLIN

Mullin Breaks The Boavista Course Record

An 83 gross, two shots inside his own previous best at the course, stands alone as the finest round played in five years of TEG golf.

David Mullin opened with an 83 gross at Boavista. It was a new course record and the best gross round recorded in TEG history to date. It arrived on his eighth visit to the venue, which is to say he had spent seven previous attempts learning where the trouble was. The old course mark of 85 had survived 35 prior visits by the field. It did not survive this one. He also beat his own best gross there by eight strokes, a margin that suggests the earlier efforts were not close.

The start gave no hint of it. He bogeyed the 1st and then the 2nd, the opening of a man about to shoot 91. Instead he stopped the slide with a birdie at the par-5 3rd, a hole he would return to at the top of his card. That birdie also handed him the outright lead in both the Green Jacket (Gross) and the Trophy (Net VP) after three holes. He then went from the 7th to the 9th without dropping a gross shot, a run of competence so unfamiliar in these parts that it deserves noting. A late bogey at the 18th did nothing to spoil it. He finished Round 1 top of the Trophy leaderboard.

AT A GLANCE
ROUND OF THE DAY David MULLIN (-3)
TROPHY LEAD David MULLIN, 1 ahead
GREEN JACKET LEAD David MULLIN, 8 ahead

ROUND NET VP
DM -3 JB -2 GW +2 HM +3 SN +6
ROUND GROSS
DM +12 JB +20 HM +23 SN +26 GW +35

AFTER R1 • TROPHY
DM -3 JB -2 GW +2 HM +3 SN +6
AFTER R1 • GREEN JACKET
DM +12 JB +20 HM +23 SN +26 GW +35

TROPHY

One Shot Behind, Eight Shots Adrift

Jon Baker twice drew level for the Trophy lead only to finish a shot back, while the same round left him eight adrift for the Green Jacket.

At Boavista in the opening round of TEG 5, Mullin and Jon Baker traded the Trophy lead all day. Mullin struck first. The birdie at the par-5 3rd gave him the outright lead in both the TEG 5 Trophy (Net VP) and the TEG 5 Green Jacket (Gross). Baker drew level with a bogey at the 4th. He drew level again with a birdie at the 16th. Neither time did he get his nose in front, which becomes the story of

the day. Mullin settled it at the last, where a bogey at the 18th was still enough to retake the Trophy lead outright. He finished the round holding it by a gap of zero on net-versus-par. A lead cannot be held by less.

The Jacket race was an altogether calmer affair. The Trophy contenders were packed into a span

running from -3 to 6. The gross scores that day ranged from 12 to 35. That is a considerably roomier neighbourhood, and it left Mullin's Jacket lead far more comfortable than his Trophy one. Both men produced their best rounds of the tournament. Mullin's 83 was a course personal best.

GREGG WILLIAMS

Ten Shots Lost In Three Holes

Gregg Williams shed nine shots in his first four holes and then ten more in his last three, signing for the worst gross score of the round.

Gregg Williams's opening round at Boavista never found any rhythm. He lost nine shots in the first four holes. It began with a triple bogey at the 1st, and was reinforced by double bogeys at the 2nd, the 3rd and the 4th. Each one was delivered with the steady regularity of a man following a plan. By the second hole he was already bottom of the TEG 5 Wooden Spoon race.

The other end of the round removed any remaining ambiguity. A double bogey at the 16th set the tone. The 17th produced a quintuple bogey, a 9 on a hole ranked among the easiest on the course by stroke index. The 18th then yielded a triple bogey, because it would have been inconsistent to stop. Ten shots gone across three holes, neatly answering the nine lost in his first four.

The middle offered nothing to build on. The round finished well outside his best figures at the course. Eight visits to Boavista have not yet produced the pace he needed here.

WOODEN SPOON

Neumann Left Holding The Spoon

The Wooden Spoon place swapped between three different players before Stuart Neumann's late trouble left him three points adrift at the bottom of the table.

At Boavista in round one of the 2012 TEG, the bottom of the Wooden Spoon table changed hands three times. Henry Meller got there first, with a quadruple bogey on the par-5 13th. Stuart Neumann then made his case. A triple bogey on the 18th was followed by another on the 16th, and last place was his. A third triple bogey, at the 5th, dropped him from third all the way to the foot of the field. A double bogey at the 7th kept him there, in case anyone had doubts. Meller briefly reclaimed the position with a double bogey at the 9th, an act of genuine generosity. Neumann repaid it with a bogey at the 10th and took the place back for good. He closed the round in last, three points clear of the trouble above him. Few men have defended a position so thoroughly.

RECORDS & PERSONAL BESTS

Notable achievements: TEG 5, Round 1

TEG RECORDS

— David Mullin's +12 (gross) is the best Gross round in TEG history to date

COURSE RECORDS

— David Mullin's 83 at Boavista — a new course record, beating 85; 35 earlier rounds there